



Sharon, can you hear me?

Six and a half years of running the town on Zoom.

"Can you hear me?"

526 times

Everyone, eventually

"You're on mute."

250 times

The Chairs, patiently

"I'll be brief."

2,000+ promises

Then spoke 4x longer

"One last thing..."

1,062 times

Longest meeting so far: 5½ hours

Chat · What do we spend meeting time on? ✕

the lake. the beach. the lake.	55 hours
where do we park?	54 hours
sewer & septic. Someone has to.	36 hours
rain, snow, is the plow coming?	29 hours
food & drink. 69 meetings on food trucks.	23 hours
dogs. More than fireworks, prom and potholes combined.	6.5 hours
backyard chickens. 2025 was the big year.	2.7 hours
potholes, in six and a half years.	23 min

The Meeting Owl (a camera) got 35 minutes. Real owls got 9.

THE FILLER CROWN

Try talking for 2,261 hours without one.

um... 323,642

vs

uh... 214,853

That's one um or uh every 16 seconds.

3	"you know".	115,688
4	"like".	100,057
5	"sort of" and "kind of"	48,885
6	"actually"	23,993
7	"sorry"	17,406
8	"hmm"	1,008

THE TOWN'S YEAR what are we talking about?

Jan

Snow, ice and geese.

Feb

The budget.

Mar

The Town Meeting warrant. Most meeting hours of any month.

Apr

Lifeguards. Hiring season at the beach. Ticks and leaves.

May

The lake, the beach, playgrounds and the town election.

Jun

Camp and water bans.

Jul

Pickleball and fireworks. The quietest month.

Aug

Mosquitoes, drought and the first day of school.

Sep

Quietest month for snow, busiest for "leaf".

Oct

Halloween! Also yard sales and coyotes.

Nov

Thanksgiving, turkeys and, for some reason, fire hydrants.

Dec

Holiday concerts, mulch and tax talk.

Participants (5) 👋 Raise your hand if you knew

GD **Geese are chased off the beach by hired dogs.**

A border collie service on a monthly contract, about six months a year.

BD **Someone breaks up the beaver dams. On purpose. Regularly.**

The conservation agent, at the old cranberry bogs, so the water keeps moving. Beavers made 52 meetings.

LK **The lake has a valve.**

The level is set by hand and read out at meetings: "the lake is at 9.8." Read out in 52 meetings.

WX **The DPW has its own weather forecaster.**

A private service with a live person on call around the clock.

PL **29 plow routes. 260 miles. One crew.**

They start at two inches and stay until it stops, whether that is two hours or two days.

"Include the cows at Crescent Ridge, or no?" Asked, during the greenhouse gas inventory. The cows were not counted.

THIS IS HOW THE WORK GETS DONE

~6,300 VOTES TAKEN

2,261 hours of public business. That's 6.6 hours a week, every week.

96% of motions carried 1,495 times "second" 1,934 times "so moved"

On average, the Select Board votes 6 times a session. School Committee 5. Finance 5. Planning 3.

TOWN MEETING: 40 VOTES ON AVERAGE

WORDS SPOKEN ON THE RECORD

22 million

That's 105 copies of Moby-Dick, or 37 of War and Peace. And 23 of those meetings ran past four hours.

FOR THE RECORD

"Muted because my dog likes to participate in the meetings."

a committee member, 2021

"I was looking for my virtual hands. I forgot about real life."

a board member, 2021

"Zoom quiet, I think, means that no one has anything to add."

a committee chair, 2020

Thank you!

56,000 thank-yous, said out loud

One every 2½ minutes of every meeting. Plus 1,966 "great jobs", 685 congratulations and 1,901 shout-outs to volunteers.

43% of all meetings mention volunteers. That's 607 meetings, and 207 of them stop to thank a volunteer group out loud.

TO OUR VOLUNTEERS, TOWN STAFF AND SHARON TV

You truly make this a nice place to live.